

**SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA
COUNTY OF VENTURA**

Tentative Ruling

**2026CUBC060741: MICHELLE R. NEWELL vs AMERICAN HONDA MOTOR CO.,
INC., A CALIFORNIA CORPORATION
07/23/2026 in Department 44
MANDATORY APPEARANCE CMC/Order to Show Cause Re Sanctions/Dismissal for
Failure to File Proof of Service/Default**

This Case Management Order (“CMO”) shall govern this litigation. If the parties have questions or concerns with any aspect of the CMO, they are directed to voice those concerns at the case management conference.

REMOTE APPEARANCES

The Court allows Zoom appearances as a courtesy to parties and counsel. The Court does not accommodate Court Call appearances. **You MUST register by 3:00 p.m. the court day before your hearing or you will be DENIED entry to the hearing:**

ZOOM Registration Link:

<https://ventura-courts-ca.zoom.us/meeting/register/iqN7uhQSQMuoQs-9TQXgEQ>

No advance notice is required to appear in person.

DEPARTMENT RULES

Parties and counsel shall follow the Department 44 rules and Zoom protocols, available at <https://www2.ventura.courts.ca.gov/Courtroom/C44>. The Court updates these rules from time to time. Counsel and parties are required to follow the operative rules.

CASE STATUS

The case is at issue and jury fees have been posted however, Defendant did not timely file a case management statement as required by CRC 3.725.

The Court will set trial to the extent Defendant agrees to rely on the information provided in Plaintiff’s case management statement. If Defendant wishes to file a statement, the Court will continue the case management conference together with an OSC why Defendant should not be sanctioned under CRC 177.50 in the amount of \$200 for failure to timely file a case management statement as required by CRC 3.725.

Defendant must appear at the CMC to indicate whether they will rely on Plaintiff’s CMC statement or request a continuance.

LITIGATION DATES:

Event	Date
Trial	January 31, 2028, at 1:30 p.m.

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Pretrial Conference	January 21, 2028, at 8:30 a.m.
All other Litigation Dates & Deadlines	Per Code of Civil Procedure

JURY TRIAL

The Court sets this matter for a 5-day **jury trial** on the above trial date in Department 44 of the Ventura County Superior Court. The trial date is a **date certain** for trial under California Rules of Court, Rule 3.1332. The Court **will not** grant any continuances but for a request made pursuant to, and good cause showing under, Rule 3.1332. Trial counsel are ordered to attend trial in person.

PRETRIAL CONFERENCE

The Court also sets a Pretrial Conference on the above pretrial conference date in Department 44. The parties are ordered to **complete mediation at least 30 days prior to the pretrial conference**, and **file a joint pretrial conference report** in accordance with the Local Rules for Department 44, which rules are incorporated into and made part of this Case Management Order. **Trial counsel are ordered to appear at the Pretrial Conference**, and may attend the pretrial conference remotely so long as trial counsel provides timely registration of their intent to appear remotely in accordance with the Court's local rules.

The OSC will be discharged.